

Full Extended Response

Workbook 1 · Learn the complete process

Goal

Build a source-based response in small pieces, then check whether each piece performs a clear job.

How to use this workbook

Read both supplied sources before writing. Complete the planner, introduction, one analytical body paragraph, and self-review. Suggested time: 45–60 minutes without a countdown.

Practice sequence

1 · Read and map

Identify each source's recommendation, strongest evidence, and main limitation.

2 · Decide and plan

Choose the better-supported argument. Record two reasons, exact evidence, analysis, and a fair comparison.

3 · Draft

Write an efficient introduction and one Point → Evidence → Analysis → Comparison paragraph.

4 · Review

Use visible evidence in the writing to judge Trait 1. Then revise one reasoning weakness.

This is original practice material. It is not an official GED test or score.

Should Downtown Stores Adopt a Shared Evening Delivery Window?

Writing task

Analyze both sources. Determine which argument is better supported by relevant evidence and reasoning. Use specific evidence from the sources to support your response.

Use only the information in the two sources. Judge which argument is better supported; do not argue from personal preference.

Source A

Continue the Evening Window With Limits

The downtown freight coordinator recommends a shared evening delivery window from 7:00 to 9:00 p.m. on four weekdays. Her office tested the schedule for six weeks on two commercial blocks where delivery vans frequently stopped in travel lanes during the morning rush. Eighteen stores and six carriers participated. Before the pilot, observers recorded an average of 31 minutes of double-parking per block between 8:00 and 10:00 a.m. During the pilot, that figure fell to 12 minutes. Average unloading time also dropped from 24 minutes to 18 because loading spaces were less likely to be occupied by customer vehicles.

The coordinator says the results support a permanent shared window, but she does not propose banning all daytime deliveries. Pharmacies, restaurants receiving perishable food, and businesses with documented staffing limits could request exemptions. The office also logged neighborhood complaints during the pilot. It received five noise complaints in the first two weeks and two in the final four weeks after carriers were told to avoid idling and rolling metal carts across residential sidewalks. Police reports showed no increase in theft or assault on the pilot blocks, although the coordinator notes that six weeks is too short to rule out a security problem.

A cost review estimated that the city would spend about \$48,000 a year on signs, curb markings, and two part-time enforcement shifts. Participating carriers reported no additional driver hours on average because routes were moved rather than extended. Four small stores said evening receiving required a manager to stay later, and two left the pilot for that reason. The coordinator therefore recommends a one-year program on the same two blocks, monthly complaint tracking, and a six-month review before expansion to other streets. She argues that the measured traffic benefit is large enough to continue, while the exemptions and review period keep the recommendation within the limits of the pilot.

Original content by Chee Skool

Source B

Keep Delivery Schedules Flexible

The Downtown Merchants Association argues that the city should keep deliveries primarily in the morning and let each business negotiate its own schedule. The association surveyed 41 member stores after the pilot; 29 responded. Seventeen respondents said they preferred morning deliveries, seven preferred the evening window, and five had no preference. Several owners wrote that evening receiving could require a supervisor to stay after normal staffing hours. One clothing shop estimated that keeping a manager for two extra hours four nights a week would cost about \$6,200 a year in wages and benefits.

The association also raises concerns about noise and security. It points to the five noise complaints filed during the first two weeks of the pilot and quotes two owners who said quieter morning streets make it easier to notice suspicious activity around loading doors. The report notes that police data showed no increase in reported theft during the six-week test, but it argues that a short pilot cannot establish long-term safety. It recommends improving morning curb enforcement instead, including higher fines for private cars that occupy loading spaces.

The association's report does not estimate how much stronger morning enforcement would reduce double-parking or how much additional enforcement would cost. It also does not separate survey responses from stores that completed the pilot and stores that left early. The report cites a delivery study from another city showing that some retailers paid higher labor costs for off-hour receiving, but that study involved large supermarkets rather than the small shops on these two blocks. The association concludes that flexible schedules are safer for small businesses because operating conditions vary widely. It asks the city to postpone any permanent evening window until merchants can compare the cost of added staffing with the value of the traffic improvement measured during the pilot.

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Exercise 1 · Build the evidence map

Use shorthand. Every evidence note should be specific enough that you can find it again in the source.

Decision	Better-supported source: _____
Reason 1	_____ _____
Exact evidence	_____ _____
Analysis	Why this evidence matters: _____ _____
Reason 2	_____ _____
Exact evidence	_____ _____
Other source	Fair point + weakness/limit: _____ _____

Decision check

Can you explain why the selected evidence is more relevant, specific, or carefully limited than the other source's support? If not, reread before drafting.

Exercise 2 · Draft the opening and one body paragraph

Introduction: frame the issue, name the better-supported source, and preview two reasons. Avoid a long topic history.

Two-sentence introduction

Body paragraph: make one evaluative point, use exact evidence, explain why it matters, and compare the other source fairly.

Point → Evidence → Analysis → Comparison

Exercise 3 · Diagnose a sample paragraph

Sample paragraph

Source A is better because it has statistics. Double-parking went down, so the evening window clearly solved every delivery problem and should be required on all downtown streets. Source B only gives opinions and is not useful.

Mark each statement Yes, Partly, or Not yet. Cite words from the sample as evidence for your judgment.

Clear evaluation

Does the paragraph judge support rather than personal preference? Yes / Partly / Not yet

Evidence: _____

Exact source use

Does it preserve the pilot's measured results and limited scope? Yes / Partly / Not yet

Evidence: _____

Analysis

Does it explain why the evidence affects the recommendation? Yes / Partly / Not yet

Evidence: _____

Fair comparison

Does it represent Source B accurately? Yes / Partly / Not yet

Evidence: _____

Answer reasoning · Compare your logic

A strong plan may differ in wording, but it should preserve these source relationships.

Decision

Source A is better supported. It uses local traffic, unloading, complaint, and police records, then limits the next step to the same two blocks. Source B raises relevant staffing and safety concerns but does not test its preferred enforcement alternative.

Reason 1 + evidence

Traffic evidence: average morning double-parking fell from 31 to 12 minutes per block, and average unloading time fell from 24 to 18 minutes. These measures directly test the curb-conflict problem the evening window targets.

Reason 2 + evidence

The recommendation fits the limits: noise complaints fell after no-idling and cart rules, police reports showed no increase in theft or assault, and the coordinator still proposes exemptions, monthly tracking, and review before any expansion.

Fair comparison

Source B usefully reports a 29-store survey and one store's \$6,200 labor estimate. However, preference does not measure traffic performance, and Source B does not estimate the cost or likely effect of stronger morning enforcement.

Model opening: Source A better supports continuing the evening delivery window because it reports local traffic and unloading results and builds the pilot's noise, staffing, and security limits into a cautious one-year plan. Source B identifies real business concerns, but it provides weaker evidence that morning scheduling and enforcement would solve the measured curb problem.

Exercise 4 · Revise with a purpose

The sample paragraph overgeneralizes a two-block pilot, dismisses Source B, and does not explain why the evidence fits the recommendation. Rewrite it below.

Revised analytical paragraph

Final check

Source accuracy

I used the traffic and unloading results accurately and kept the two-block, six-week limits.

Analysis

I explained why the evidence strengthens or limits the recommendation.

Comparison

I included one fair point about Source B before judging its weaker support.